

BIBLIOGRAPHY : CHRISTIAN EGYPT, 1915—1916*.

By W. E. CRUM, M.A.

1. *Biblical.* There have been considerable additions to the stock of printed Sa'idic texts this year. Over half of the 67 numbers in WESSELY's 15th volume¹ are biblical and include fragments from all parts of the bible. A few are fayyumic (Psalms, Mark). Among the latter, no. 232 is bilingual and, if not a part of Br. Mus. no. 504 (*v.* below), has a strong resemblance to that valuable MS. It may be assumed that, as hitherto usual, the vellum MSS. are generally from the White Monastery, those on papyrus (a small minority) from the Fayyûm or Ashmunên.

Prof. WORRELL's *Psalter* need only be referred to, since it was noticed specially last year (*v. Journal*, III, 226).

H. MUNIER edits² fragments of Genesis and Revelation, noting in the former that the proper names follow generally the forms of the *Cod. Alex.*, though occasionally reproducing the Hebrew reading; also passages of Lu., Ac., Ps. and Rom. from a semi-fayyumic lectionary. The first and third of these are from the find at Hamûli in the Fayyûm, whence came the Morgan Collection.

L. DELAPORTE republishes³ a papyrus text of Matt. vii, which had originally been facsimiled in Jomard's *Voyage* (1821).

MUNIER's Catalogue of the Cairo MSS.⁴ (*v.* review below, pp. 67–70) likewise contains some 25 biblical pieces, mostly from the Psalter and New Testament. We may note especially no. 9239, which can be recognized as part of the bilingual Br. Mus. no. 504 (*v.* above).

The psalms and lessons for the feasts of Mercurius, of Michael and of Aaron of Philae are appended to their Encomiums in BUDGE's latest volume⁵. For the first the lessons are from Lu., Matt. (two) and Mk.; for the second from Matt. (two), I Tim., I Pet., Ac. and Lu.; for the last from He., Ja., Ac., Matt., Mk. (including last 12 vv.). For the first (the MS. is dated 983) the texts are in Greek and Coptic.

G. HOBERG and P. KETTER describe and estimate the collection of Bohairic leaves, from Psalters and Lectionaries, brought from the Nitrian monasteries by H.R.H. John

* This Bibliography, which I have undertaken owing to Mr Gaselee's occupations at the Foreign Office, would have been more scanty even than it is but for help from various friends: Messrs Gaselee, Gardiner, Griffith, Sir H. Thompson and particularly Mr E. O. Winstedt.

¹ *Studien zur Paläographie*, xv (1914).

² *Bull. Inst. Franç.*, xii, 243.

³ *Rev. Bibl.* 1916, 560.

⁴ *Catal. Gén.*, nos. 9201—9304, Cairo, 1916.

⁵ *Miscellaneous Coptic Texts*, 1915, 249, 422, 496.

George of Saxony¹. None seems of any age and none of importance, save a fragment of Joel, the text of which is said to be preferable to those published.

A publication, presumably of biblical texts (papyri and ostraca), by PAUL M. MEYER, is referred to in the *Wochenschr. f. klass. Philol.* 1916, 2 Oct.²

2. *Apocryphal, Gnostic.* Egyptian forms of Gnosticism occupy considerable space in F. LEGGE's book³. In particular, a full and careful analysis (ch. x) of the *Pistis Sophia* and the Bruce Papyrus is perhaps the best presentment of those works for English readers; nor is there another equally satisfactory account of the Valentinian doctrines (ch. ix).

BUDGE's volume, already referred to, contains⁴ one important text to be classed here: a large part of the *Apocalypse of Paul*, a title justified by internal evidence. But the precise relation of the Coptic to other versions of this 'Revelation' still remains to be investigated. It appears to be largely amplified and to come nearest to the Latin.

The *Acta Pauli* appear in MUNIER's Catalogue (v. above), no. 9230, where the editor records the variants from C. Schmidt's text.

No. 9228 of the same Catalogue, relating to Christ before Pilate, looks like a narrative of the type of the *Gospel of Nicodemus*, or some similar apocryphon.

In WESSELY's 'Studies' (v. above) no. 244 is from the *Gospel of Bartholomew*, corresponding to pp. 2—10 of Budge's *Coptic Apocrypha*. No. 196 shows the opening of the Martyrdom of James son of Zebedee, while nos. 201, 202 and 242 (the latter the editor has not identified) are from the Acts of John by Prochorus and from his 'Assumption.' When are we to see a critical collection of the countless scattered fragments of these various apostolic Acts? The materials are for the most part within easy reach by now and no task would better employ a Coptic scholar. The latest views on this subject are to be found in K. LAKE's article, *Apocryphal Acts*, in Hastings's new dictionary⁵, where much space is devoted to the Coptic *Acta Pauli*.

MOFFAT's learned article in the same work, on *Uncanonical Gospels*, has much to say of the Egyptian remnants of these writings.

MOFFAT discusses⁶ the medico-magical texts in *Pap. Oxyrh.* xi, p. 238, regarding the first as reminiscent of some unidentified gospel; the second more doubtfully. He remarks on the "close association in Egypt of piety and the healing art."

A review of the second instalment of Revillout's *Apocrypha* (v. *Report* 1912-13, 51) by A. ALLGEIER⁷ is chiefly interested in the *Acta Pilati*, the value whereof is increased owing to the late date of the Greek MSS. used by Tischendorf.

3. *Liturgical.* The antiquity of the liturgy embodied in the 'Egyptian Church Order' is criticized by BATIFFOL⁸, who regards it as an artificial composition, at least as late as the *Descensus ad Inferos*.

The text publications already cited each contribute something here. WESSELY's no. 204 is from a Directory of lessons for "the days of communion (συνάγειν) and the festivals throughout the year"; no. 250 is a 'farced' *Trisagion* in Greek, with petitions

¹ *Oriens Christianus*, NS., v, 138.

² *Forerunners and Rivals of Christianity*, London, 1915.

³ *Dict. of the Apostolic Church*, I, 1915.

⁴ *Oriens Chr.*, NS., iv, 354.

⁵ See *Class. Quart.*, xi, 56.

⁶ BUDGE, *op. cit.*, 534, 1054.

⁷ *Expos. Times*, 1916, 424.

⁸ *Rev. Bibl.*, 1916, 23.

for the inundation (*cf.* Rylands, no. 53, p. 23, Leyden *MSS.* p. 129); no. 251 from a litany, with petitions for the monastic clergy, the emperor, and the pagarch.

MUNIER's no. 9226 is from a bilingual Antiphonary of Psalm verses; no. 9260 is from a litany, including the diptychs.

The lessons already referred to in BUDGE's volume for the festival of Mercurius (25th Hathor) are interspersed with others for Christmas (29th Koiahk) and Epiphany (11th Tobe). The reason of this needs explanation. The lessons for St Michael's day were to be read at Vespers and Matins.

The expository Arabic paraphrases (*tafâsîr*), read after the lessons in the Coptic church on Sundays and festivals, are being printed by the *hegumenus* PHILOTHEUS and Joseph bey MANCARIUS¹. In the lengthy Introduction I find nothing as to origin or traditional authorship.

EVELYN-WHITE publishes² a Greek hymn on an ostrakon from the New York excavations, which resembles certain others, but is difficult to class precisely.

In a learned article upon Greek hymnology³ BAUMSTARK has a paragraph on those from Egypt, their importance and the generally deplorable state of the texts. He holds the monophysite form of the *Trisagion* to be contemporary with the *Octoechus* of Severus.

An interesting record of Coptic church music is made by KAMIL IBRAHIM GABRIÂL, a lieutenant in the Sudan army, who prints the notation of the melodies of 55 of the 'Responses' (*maraddât*), accompanied by the Coptic words, in their present pronunciation. A second part is to follow⁴.

SCHERMANN has studied the Egyptian festal calendar and described its growth out of a short list of weekly and annual festivals, down to the 7th century⁵. He has also written upon the *Agape* in Egypt and upon the origin of the liturgy of the reserved sacrament⁶.

"The rite of the habiting with the leathern *σχημα*," among Syrian (uniate) monks, is the subject of an article by L. A. RÜCKER⁷. The rite is said to be adapted from the Coptic (Tuki, *Pontificale*, 176 ff.) and to owe its origin to St Anthony.

S. A. B. MERCER translates the Ethiopic Liturgy from a modern MS. and prefixes a valuable study on its sources and development, comparing it with the Egyptian forms, both Greek and Coptic⁸. An unsigned review⁹ says of the Abyssinian Church (1) that it "can boast of having preserved the apostolic faith untainted by Nestorian opinions" and (2) that it is "strictly Monophysite"—two different ways of describing the same doctrinal position.

4. *Church Literature.* MUNIER's Cairo Catalogue contains a good proportion of homiletic pieces—a number of them from 'l'inévitable Shenouté'—some of which are discussed in my review (*v.* below).

¹ *Tuhfah 'l-amgâd fi tafsîr fuṣūl al-âhâd wa 'l-a'yâd*, vol. 1, Cairo, 1914.

² *Journ. Th. St.*, xvii, 171.

³ HASTINGS, *Dict. Relig. and Ethics*, vii, 8.

⁴ *Al-tawaqqa'ât al-musiḡīyah li-maraddât al-kanîsah al-marḡusiyah*, pt. i, Cairo, 1916.

⁵ *Theologie u. Glaube*, 1913, 89 (quoted *Byz. Z.*, xxii, 593).

⁶ *L.c.*, 1913, 177 (*ib.*, 594).

⁷ *Or. Christ.*, NS., iv, 219.

⁸ *The Ethiopic Liturgy*, Milwaukee and London, 1915.

⁹ *Athenæum*, 1916, 182.

LEMM makes a further small contribution towards the study of the Coptic *Apothevmata*¹ and incidentally gives a list of the Greek MSS. which were used by P. Nikitin in preparing his edition. We trust that the latter's death (*Times*, 20. 5. 16) does not end our hopes, already long deferred, of some day seeing that invaluable publication.

Ammonius-Ammonas-Amoun-(A)p'amoun is among the most frequent names in ascetic literature. A Syriac version of the Epistles ascribed to one of the name was edited in *Patr. Or.* x. NAU reprints² the Greek text from a recent Jerusalem edition, with variants and with all else that can be attributed to this writer, whom he identifies with the disciple of Antony. Incidentally Nau expresses the view that, in the 4th cent., Coptic had in Egypt no wider importance than Breton has in France to-day; the native tongue came by its own only after Chalcedon.

A note on p. 395 of the last-named article calls attention to a recent edition, from Jerusalem, by a monk named AUGUSTINUS, of the long wanted Greek text of Esaias of Scete.

What seems to be the only extant sermon of Pesynthius of Coptos—nominally a panegyric on Onnophrius—is included in BUDGE's volume (p. 1206) and is re-edited and translated by CRUM³.

The studies of Clement of Alexandria noticed in *Report* 1913-14, 29, together with several other recent works, form the basis of a long article by P. V. M. BENECKE⁴, who sketches Clement's life and discusses difficulties of interpretation, sequence of his writings, his position in early church history, the canon of scripture accepted by him and the type of text used, his classical quotations, his claims to philosophical originality, his attitude toward paganism, his theological position, and his value at the present day.

What Clement understood by the capacity for deification, ascribed by early Christian writers to man, is investigated by G. W. BUTTERWORTH⁵, who concludes that the conception shows the unconscious absorption of Platonic ideas. C. LATTEY criticizes this⁶, holding that Pauline influences are here stronger than Butterworth realizes and pointing out that Clement moreover lived where the conception of deified kingship was of immemorial antiquity.

"The So-called Egyptian Church Order and Derived Documents" is the title of an investigation by Dom R. H. CONNOLLY⁷, who concludes that this text is the earliest main source of all the other orders, being in fact the *Paradosis* of Hippolytus.

An Arabic abstract or compendium of the Pachomian Rule, as to-day observed, was procured by H.R.H. John George of Saxony when in Egypt and is translated by P. KARGE on p. 19 of the book described below (v. p. 55).

The position of the Roman see at the Council of Chalcedon is of importance to those to-day aiming at 'reunion.' A clear narrative, with translations, is given by C. H. SHARPE⁸, who incidentally relates the events which led to the condemnation of Dioscorus of Alexandria.

The homily attributed to Cyril of Alexandria which Grohmann lately edited (v. *Report* 1913-14, 29) is criticised by G. GRAF⁹, who (without offering much to support it) declares its original language to be Arabic, rather than Coptic, and emends various renderings of ecclesiastical terms in the translation.

¹ *Miscellen* § CXLIV (*Bull. Ac. Imp.*, 1914, 933).

³ *R.O.C.*, xx, 38.

⁵ *Journ. Th. St.*, xvii, 157.

⁸ *More Hall Quart. Mag.*, v, no. 18.

² *Patr. Or.*, xi, 393.

⁴ *Church Quarterly Rev.*, 1916, 301.

⁷ *Texts and Studies*, viii.

⁹ *ZDMG.*, lxix, 365.

To the much discussed problem as to the genuine and the pseudo-Macarius of Egypt G. L. MARRIOTT contributes three notes¹. Nos. 1 and 2 prove borrowings from the *Historia Lausiaca*, no. 3 borrowings of the Metaphrast from Macarius.

The Ethiopic text of an ascetic Epistle, ascribed to Macarius and addressed to 'his children,' is edited and translated by TURATIEF².

A very favourable review of P. Scott-Moncrieff's *Paganism and Christianity* by T. NICKLIN³, criticizes however the author's views upon the beginnings of Alexandrine Christianity and upon the extra-canonical gospels.

5. *History, Legends, etc.* BUDGE's last volume, referred to above, consists mainly of texts which might be classified either under this or, in so far as they have the form of spoken discourses, under the foregoing heading. We are given 21 mostly complete Coptic texts (close on 600 pp.), with the usual introductions, translations, and indexes—unquestionably a very serious addition to our material. Besides 4 Encomiums on the Virgin, attributed to Cyril of Jerusalem, Demetrius (*sic*) of Antioch, Epiphanius of Salamis, and Cyril of Alexandria respectively, there are 3 on Michael by Severus, Theodosius (the Bohairic versions being in the editor's *St Michael*), and Timothy, 1 on Gabriel by Celestine, 1 on Raphael by Chrysostom, and a discourse on the Invocation of the Cross by Cyril of Jerusalem. The martyrs whose praises are sung are Theodore the Eastern (by Theodore of Antioch), Mercurius (3 independent texts), and Psote of Ptolemais. The remaining pieces, besides the Apocalypse of Paul above mentioned, are a Prayer of the dying Athanasius and a highly interesting but incomplete narrative concerning the conversion and early hermits of the Nubian districts about Philæ. The sermon of Pesynthius mentioned above (p. 50) is added as an appendix. A review with some identifications and suggestions has appeared in the *Times*⁴.

As MUNIER's Catalogue is reviewed in this number of the *Journal*, it need only be noted here that about a quarter of its total numbers would be classed here and that these include some highly interesting texts, both strictly historical and purely legendary.

Among WESSELY's new texts (*v.* above) may be mentioned no. 194, the close of the story of Samuel of Kalamon, which was to have been utilized by the lamented Van Cauwenbergh in his edition of the Morgan MS. of these Acts; no. 197, from the Acts of Macarius of Tkôw; nos. 199, 243, Acts of the Council of Ephesus; no. 200 (fol. 1 at any rate), from the history of John of Lycopolis; no. 238, perhaps the story of Gesius and Isidore (*v.* Rylands no. 97); no. 241, from the 'Ecclesiastical History,' being the same MS. as Br. Mus. no. 326 etc.; no 245, from the Acts and Epistles of Peter of Alexandria (cf. *J. Th. St.* 1903, 387), including his 3rd Letter to Diocletian; no. 247, from the Martyrdom of Paêse (cf. Zoega cxliii); no. 248, the history of Archellides; no. 249, that of Marinus; nos. 252, 253, the Martyrdom of Ignatius of Antioch.

BASSET's text and translation of the *Synaxarium* makes steady if slow progress⁵. The months of Tubah and Amshir still allow of his drawing upon the interesting Upper Egyptian recension assigned to Nagadah or its neighbourhood. (Cf. *Report* 1908-09, 63. It is, by the way, evident from Legrain's book, noticed below, that other copies of this recension are still extant at Luxor.) The rendering of proper

¹ *Journal Th. St.*, xviii, 68.

² *Christianskye Vostok*, iv, 141.

³ *Class. Rev.*, 1916, 193.

⁴ *Lit. Suppl.*, 27. 1. 16.

⁵ *Patr. Or.*, xi, 507.

names—a weak point with every editor so far—is far from adequate; *e.g.*, p. 519 *Taousitos* should be Theopistus, p. 597 *Maharati* Ama Herai, p. 653 *Bartanouba* Protonike, p. 666 *Badasyous* Ambrosius(?), p. 684 *Ephraim* Abraham. Basset seems content with the exact reproduction of the forms of his MSS.

MUNIER mentions¹ a fragment of a Martyrdom of Isidore, as yet unidentified. Cf. *Synaxarium*, 18th Barmhat and 19th Bashans, and Lemm, *Br. Kopt. Märt.*

LEMM prints and translates² three fragments, the first of which obviously relates to Chrysostom and Eudoxia; but how the others, which show a dialogue between an archbishop and a 'Chalcedonian,' are imagined to be connected with this is not clear. The lacking number of the Paris fragment should be 129⁴, 132.

The Arabic translation—fuller than either Coptic recension—of the Life of Pesynthius of Coptos (*v. Report* 1912–13, 26) is referred to by GRIVEAU³, in a note on the prophetic Letter of that bishop, which he holds to have influenced the Ethiopic *Clement*, an Arabic text whereof he is editing.

One of the most interesting 'historical' texts preserved in Coptic—and this time probably in its original dialect—is the Life of Isaac, Coptic patriarch near the close of the 7th century. Amélineau's edition was inadequate and we are grateful for a fresh one by PORCHER⁴, whose careful transcript throws the inaccuracies and licence of the former edition into strong relief.

E. DRIOTON begins a reprint and translation⁵ of that part of the Life of the Oxyrhynchite bishop Aphou (*ed.* F. Rossi) which narrates his discussion with the patriarch Theophilus as to the anthropomorphite views expressed in the latter's Festal Letter. D. regards the text as a document of first-rate importance. It may be remarked that the Turin papyri seem to have come from This, near Girgeh, and that an investigation of this text was made by Bolotoff, in the *Christianskya Chtenya*, 1886.

In his abstracts of various Syriac *Acta*, NAU includes two ascetics of Egyptian birth and training⁶: Yaret, an Alexandrian (of Syrian origin, to judge by his name), who, after quitting the Pachomian community, joins Eugenius in Mesopotamia; and James the recluse, who, in the time of Julian, left his monastery near Alexandria and, after three years in the Mareotic desert, likewise migrated to Mesopotamia.

In an article on *Apollo and St Michael*⁷ G. F. HILL refers to the story of the conversion of the Saturn temple at Alexandria into a church of the archangel and speculates as to the identity of the god formerly worshipped in it.

Miss MURRAY discusses⁸ certain personal and place names in the Grail legend and claims to have made probable an Egyptian origin for the incidents connected with Joseph of Arimathea. Several interesting photographs. Miss Murray's claims are criticized by Miss JESSIE WESTON⁹, who holds the recension in question to be too recent to justify its use for the identification of sources. An Egyptian consecration legend may however perhaps be embedded in it.

Which of the three brothers Ibn al-ʿAssâl is the author of the *Nomocanon* (*Fetha Nagast*)? Mallon had claimed it for As-Safî, a contention which P. DIB supports with fresh arguments¹⁰.

¹ *Bull. Inst. Franç.*, XII, 253.

³ *R.O.C.*, XIX, 441.

⁶ *R.O.C.*, XIX, 432, XX, 3.

⁸ *Anc. Egypt*, 1916, i, 54.

² *Miscellen* § CXLI (*Bull. Ac. Imp.*, 1914, 915).

⁴ *Patr. Or.*, XI, 301.

⁹ *Ib.*, 186.

⁵ *R.O.C.*, XX, 92.

⁷ *Journ. Hellen. St.*, 1916, 134.

¹⁰ *R.O.C.*, XX, 104.

The 1st volume (530 pp.) of an *Epitome of the History of the Coptic People*, by Salīm Sulaimān, a secondary-schoolmaster in Cairo, appeared in 1914¹. It covers the pagan period and the Christian, down to the 4th century. Diligent use has been made of certain modern works, but the standpoint is said to be reactionary.

I learn that R. H. CHARLES's long looked-for translation of the Chronicle of John of Nikiu is at last in the press. Amélineau boasted (*v. p. xxiv* of the Introduction to his *Hist. du patr. Isaac*) of knowing the whereabouts of the Arabic text, whence the Ethiopic was translated. Has the secret died with him?

6. *Non-literary texts.* The 3rd and posthumous volume of JEAN MASPERO's Catalogue of the Byzantine Papyri at Cairo² is of course one of the most important publications of the year (*v. review, Journ. III, 288*). Some points concerning the present bibliography may be noted. From no. 67283 we get an interesting list of the Aphrodito churches. No. 67286 shows that in the 6th century that town had to contribute towards the support of the monastery of the *Metanoia* (presumably at Alexandria). No. 67295 illustrates episcopal jurisdiction, which here extends to civil complaints. In No. 67326 (*an. 542*) a married bishop is mentioned. In no. 67298 we see a church at Denderah as landowner. No. 67307 relates to a church in Aphrodito and its tenants. The testator in 67312 leaves land to the White Monastery and to that of Moses (one is tempted here to read the place-name *Abydos*). No. 67299 has another example of a monk's swearing by the monastic habit.

Among the earliest private letters of distinctly Christian character are four in GRENFELL's new volume. They date from about A.D. 300³.

In HUNT's 2nd volume of the Rylands Greek Papyri⁴ are three fresh *libelli*, certifying to their holders having performed the required pagan sacrifices and dating from A.D. 250. An example from Oxyrhynchus, of the same date, shows somewhat unusual formulas⁵.

We are glad to see a revival of LEFÉBVRE's intermittent publication of Christian texts from stelæ⁶. He prints some 30 from Antinoe, of the 7th—8th centuries, half being in Greek, half in Coptic. Horion, a local saint, is invoked on some. One is from Boşreh, S. of Assiût.

A Greek grave-stele from Erment, with an interesting text and the name *Alchis*, is published by EVELYN-WHITE; also another, with the name *Plein* (hardly 'Pliny')⁷.

Excavations of various sites between Derût and Dêr Ganadleh conducted by AHMAD BEY KAMÂL⁸ have produced some Coptic graffiti, with invocations, naming Jeremias and Enoch, as at Saḳḳareh. They are very inadequately copied. Further, some ostraca from Mankabad, N. of Assiût.

BARSANTI's excavations at Kom Ombo have produced a few Coptic remains⁹.

Those interested in contemporary Egyptian literature and folk-lore will value the large collection of native songs—some by living authors, most traditional—which G. MASPERO edited (in transcription) and translated, not long before his death¹⁰. They

¹ *Mukhtaṣar Tārīkh al-Ummah al-Qibṭīyah*, vol. I, Cairo, 1914.

² *Catal. Gén.*, Pap. Gr., III, 1916.

⁴ *Catal. of the Gk. Papyri in the Rylands Library*, II, 94—96.

⁵ *Oxyrh. Pap.*, XII, no. 1464.

⁷ *Bull. Metrop. Mus. of Art*, N. York, XI, 48.

⁹ *Ib.*, 168.

³ *Oxyrh. Pap.*, XII, nos. 1492—1495.

⁶ *Ann. du Serv.*, xv, 113.

⁸ *Ann. du Serv.*, xv, 177.

¹⁰ *Ib.*, xiv, 97.

relate to several aspects and events of domestic life in Upper Egypt; but they are drawn little from the distinctly Christian element in the population. The mention, on p. 146, of Coptic 'weeping women,' at funerals at Denderah, may be noted.

The same may be said of the songs in LEGRAIN's interesting book on the folk-lore of modern Thebes¹. A few only are ascribed to the Copts of Minyeh and Assiût.

This book however contains other matter which should be mentioned here. We learn that the Diocletian martyrs Shenetôm, Talitsene (elsewhere Kalisthene), and Sophronius, buried along the river-bank at Luxor, have been identified by the Muslims with healing saints of their own and are to-day honoured with mosques and a local festival. A more important festival, the fair at Kamûleh in honour of *Abû Sifain*, is described at length. Is this the famous military saint (Mercurius) of Old Cairo, who had shrines too, still further south, at Esneh and Edfu? The *Synaxarium*, at the date in question (25th Abib), does not enlighten us. Another chapter recounts the legend, current to-day, of the rebuilding in 1840 of the monastery of Pachomius, near Luxor, by the zeal of a pious Muslim, to whom the saint in a vision had himself appeared.

7. *Philological*. A highly important contribution to Egyptian philology, and not merely to Egyptian, has been made by SETHE in his study of the names of the numbers and numerals² (v. review, *Journal* III, 279—286). Incidentally he of course discusses the Coptic forms of the words and their grammatical employment, besides the various expressions for fractions and parts, throwing new light on many points. Two of the arithmetical texts discussed date indeed from Christian times (for one cf. *Report* 1913-14, 33 *infra*). Of the interesting and puzzling tables and problems in the MS. Br. Mus. Cat. no. 528 he says nothing.

The favour shown by ERMAN and his disciples to the southern over the once exclusively studied northern (Bohairic) dialect of Coptic was due to their recognition of its greater morphological antiquity, and has led to a perhaps undue neglect of the idiom which was once the 'Coptic' *par excellence*. Starting from a comparison of their respectively abbreviated or fuller vocalization, Erman has now seen reason to revise some of his (and Steindorff's) conclusions³; and he shows how the deceptive simplicity of Sa'idic structure not infrequently betrays the action of levelling analogy, in phonetic processes, thus leaving the Bohairic forms after all the more interesting and primitive.

Several of VON LEMM's *Miscellen* are, as usual, concerned with linguistic criticism⁴. No. cxlii examines the supposed place-name *Illarté*. No. cxliii suggests various emendations to Crum's *Theological Texts*. No. cxlv deals with Hengstenberg's edition of an illiterate malediction (v. *Report* 1913-14, 33). No. cxliv discusses a form of the verb *ⲥⲣⲓⲧ* 'glean'; while cxlvi explains the strange word *ⲉⲡⲟⲩⲩ*, Zoega, p. 353. Nos. cxlviii, cxlix are a long series of suggested emendations to Budge's 'Gospel of Bartholomew.' No. cl aims at explaining a use of *κεφάλαιον*, frequently found in the dedicatory colophons of Coptic MSS.

GARDINER adds four more to the still very modest list of ascertained hieroglyphic etymologies for Coptic words, viz. for *ⲙⲓⲛⲉ*, *ⲙⲟⲗ*, *ⲥⲱⲧ* and *ⲭⲱⲣⲏ*⁵.

¹ *Louqsor sans les Pharaons*, Bruxelles et Paris, 1914.

² *Von Zahlen u. Zahlwortern bei den alten Aegyptern*, Strassburg, 1916.

³ *Sitzb.*, Berlin Academy, 1915, 180.

⁴ *Bull. Ac. Imp.*, 1914, 924; 1915, 205—226. Nos. cl ff. are printed privately, not in the *Bulletin*.

⁵ *PSBA.*, 1916, 181.

G. MASPERO was engaged upon a general introduction to Egyptian grammar and had printed¹ a section, treating of the values of the letters, wherein the problems presented by the Coptic alphabet also come in for examination.

His son gives acute interpretations of certain obviously non-arabic words from the Patriarchal Chronicle². [For one on p. 51 I would suggest ἀποκρισιάριος, which goes well beside νοτάριος.]

The investigation of Greek pronunciation, as illustrated in Coptic transcription, has not yet advanced far, though material has never lacked. GASELEE has some observations³ on works of Rahlfs, Wessely and Crum which relate to this subject.

Careful study of the texts is evident in SCHLEIFER's long review⁴ of Rösch's *Clement* (and incidentally of C. Schmidt's). Many emendations are suggested.

Labib's Dictionary, brought, I hear, to a standstill through the war, is to have a rival. G. PH. AWAD has acquired a transcript (by the author) of the late learned bishop Agapius Bishai's manuscript and proposes, with the help of two Catholic Coptic priests, to publish it, adding an exhaustive appendix of ecclesiastical words and making full use of the principal medieval *scalæ*. This ought to be a valuable work and it is to be hoped that the enterprise will be carried through.

The above information is taken from the same author's critical studies in the Coptic tongue, whereof the first part⁵ contains introductory notes on native and European grammarians (it is significant that Tattam alone among the latter is mentioned) and a detailed examination of the values of the Coptic letters. The author is inclined to be critical of Labib's dictionary, taking as his criterion the *scala* of Ibn Kabr, *ed.* Kircher, and adding quotations from Bishai's MS.

Reference was again made, in last year's *Report*, to the Coptic dictionary upon which CRUM has long been engaged. As a reply to various enquiries, it may be stated that, though the war still renders collaboration, both English and foreign, impracticable, the collection of material continues to progress, steadily if slowly.

8. *Art, Archaeology, Excavations*. A very useful article by DARESSY⁶ aims at a classification, according to variety of material and types of decoration, of the Christian stelæ in Cairo. He also corrects various previous statements as to *provenance* which had, in earlier years, been recorded here with notorious carelessness.

H.R.H. JOHN GEORGE of Saxony paid visits to Egypt in 1910 and 1912 and had already described some of his acquisitions in the periodicals (v. *Report* 1913-14, 36). His account⁷ of what, under exceptional conditions, he was enabled to see and his reflections on the present state of Christian antiquities, especially in Upper Egypt, are often interesting. Among the 240 photographs, many are new and valuable, though some have come out upside down (nos. 19, 32, 102, 107, 108, 148). Fragments of bible MSS. brought from the Nitrian monasteries have been noticed above (pp. 47-8).

I do not think that an article by SCHERMANN has been recorded here⁸, which treats of various church antiquities (instruments, furniture) and functions, in use in Egypt between the 3rd and 6th centuries.

¹ *Rec. de Trav.*, xxxvii, 147, xxxviii, 85.

³ *Class. Rev.*, 1916, 6.

⁵ *Al-lujah al-qibṭiyah—al-mabḥath al-auwal*, Cairo, 1916.

⁷ *Streifzüge durch die Kirchen und Klöster Aegyptens*, Leipzig, 1914.

⁸ *Theologie u. Glaube*, 1912, 817.

² *Bull. Inst. Franç.*, xii, 43.

⁴ *ZDMG.*, lxix, 184.

⁶ *Ann. du Serv.*, xiii, 266.

Mrs BUTCHER has collected and classified the various forms of the cross to be found upon Egyptian monuments¹. She gives a number of drawings, but suggests no dates.

The fresco from Wādy Sarga, now in the British Museum (v. *Report* 1914-15, 35), has been published by DALTON². It shows SS. Cosmas and Damianus, below them Anthimus, Leontius and Euprepus, and, in the background, the 3 Children, with accompanying angel, in the furnace. In the inscription "the threescore Martyrs of Siut" are mentioned (?invoked). D. assigns it to about A.D. 600.

It appears that the valuable bible MSS. of the Freer collection have illuminated bindings. These are published and investigated by C. R. MOREY³. One cover shows the 4 Evangelists, the other the Evangelists, writing, besides other scenes. The pictures are of course not contemporary with the MSS. themselves. An appreciative review by ROUSE has appeared⁴.

In describing⁵ a private collection of Egyptian antiquities, GRIFFITH includes one or two Coptic bronze objects and a lamp inscribed with the name of a St Joseph. He mentions one at Oxford similarly naming St Sergius.

The British Museum has acquired "a valuable collection of Coptic antiquities" (22 numbers), including "wooden objects used at the celebration of the eucharist⁶."

A peculiar type, called by C. M. KAUFMANN the 'tube cross,' since its metal arms are cylindrical, is described by him and its known instances enumerated⁷.

BAUMSTARK investigates the type and probable origin of the well-known miniatures of the Gospel MS. in the *Institut Catholique*⁸. Comparing various Syriac and Armenian illuminations, he assumes a fairly early Syro-Hellenistic model.

Reviews by STRZYGOWSKI⁹ discuss two works formerly noticed here: Somers Clarke's *Christian Antiquities* (v. *Report* 1912-13, 66) and Lethaby's publication of the South Kensington textiles (v. *Report* 1913-14, 36). As to the former, he regrets that the original scheme of triple collaboration was never carried through and he blames the official neglect of 'Coptic' monuments. He notes that Somers Clarke says nothing of the church at Denderah. In Lethaby he finds a partizan of his own theories about the development of Christian art.

The pagan origins of the Coptic calendar, the etymologies of the month-names (p. 86), and other related matters are the subject of a work by G. PH. AWAD¹⁰, whose linguistic studies have been noticed above. A large number of tables are also given for the calculation of Easter, New Year, and other festivals.

9. *Miscellaneous*.—Paragraphs were again to be read in the press, last summer¹¹, regarding the still very unsatisfactory relations between the aged Coptic patriarch and the Coptic laity, as to the management of the internal affairs of the community, more especially touching the administration of the valuable *Wakfs* (or pious foundations), which the younger laymen would, it is well known, prefer to see directed by the government, like the corresponding Muslim property. The war however seems to have

¹ *Anc. Egypt*, 1916, 97.

² *Univ. of Michigan Studies*, XII (1), New York.

³ *Journ. Eg. Arch.*, III, 197.

⁴ *Or. Christ.*, NS., IV, 306.

⁵ *Asās al-Taḡāwīm* etc., Cairo, 1915.

⁶ *Journ. Eg. Arch.*, III, 35.

⁷ *Class. Rev.*, 1915, 253.

⁸ *B.M. Return.*, 1916, 37.

⁹ *Byzant. Zeit.*, XXII, 282, 624.

¹⁰ *Near East*, 1916, Jul. 14, Aug. 11.

¹¹ *Ib.*, 341.

put a stop to the hoped-for reforms, although the patriarch was reported to have admitted the deplorable situation of the church properties.

A patriarch of advanced age died in Egypt, in January 1916. From the Egyptian press notices¹, there is no doubt this was the Melkite (or Greek-catholic) Cyril VIII, whose see extended over Syria and Egypt. A 'Coptic correspondent' in the *Guardian*² however writes an obituary of the aged Coptic patriarch, Cyril V, who, for years past, has been the mainstay of the conservative, anti-progressive section of his community. The dates of the papers cited in the preceding paragraph show that Cyril V was still living in August last.

Coptic studies have recently lost two of their oldest contributors. GASTON MASPERO found time for several Coptic publications of importance: chief among them, the edition of the Paris Old Testament fragments (*Méms. de la Miss.*, vi), indispensable until the critical text we all hope for shall appear. Further, the papyrus Psalter fragments copied early in the century by Des Rivières and printed by Maspero in his *Études Égyptiennes*; and the highly interesting crusader's conversation-manual, in medieval French and Coptic, edited first in *Romania*, vol. XVII (1888), 481—512, and reprinted in the *Bibliothèque Égyptologique*, XXVII, 175—212. An enduring monument to Maspero's interest in Christian Egypt exists in the great collection of stelæ and architectural relics brought together through his initiative, first in the Bulak, now in the Cairo Museum.

Another French scholar, E. AMÉLINEAU, who died in January 1915, was not only hitherto the most prolific editor of Coptic texts, but also the author of a number of books relating to the history, literature, and folk-lore of the Copts which are likely to outlive his text publications and deserve to do so. For while the latter leave us indeed under an undeniable debt towards Amélineau's vast diligence, the standard of accuracy and respect for his originals with which he was content—he almost boasts that he is no impeccable editor—are such as to cause us nevertheless to regret that the *editio princeps* of so many texts of the first importance should have been reserved by fate for him. On the other hand, in such books as his *Actes des Martyres*, his *Contes et Romans*, his *Vie de Schnoudi*, he displays an enviable gift of popularization, which has made a large public familiar with the far-off subjects of his studies. Of his few technical publications, the *Géographie de l'Égypte à l'époque copte* is undoubtedly the most valuable, though to-day it obviously needs revision and enlargement.

P.S.—I can only here mention the publication by H. MUNIER³ of part of a welcome Sa'idic text of the Life of Maximus and Dometius, whence the long known Bohairic version was doubtless abridged.

¹ *Bourse Égyptienne*, Jan. 11, *Al-Mokattam*, Jan. 14 etc.

² *The Guardian*, 20 Jan., 1916. The *Times* had made the same mistake on Jan. 12, but corrected it on Feb. 10.

³ *Bull. Inst. Franç.*, XIII, 93.